

Prior Authorization Request - Allergen Immunotherapy

Health Plan

Humana Medicare Advantage. Plan ID: H5216-014-000. Request type: standard pre-service review.
Date of request: 2026-10-04

Member Information

Member: Dana Okoye DOB: 1992-01-19 (age 34) Member ID: MBR-8835
Address: 209 Willow Court, Columbus, OH Phone: 555-0256

Requesting Provider

Dr. Linda Cho -- Allergy and Immunology. NPI: 6234567895
Practice: Capital Allergy and Immunology
Phone: 555-0267 Fax: 555-0268

Requested Service

Requested service: Subcutaneous allergen immunotherapy (SCIT), antigen preparation and provision for a course of injections
CPT 95165 ICD-10: J30.2 (other seasonal allergic rhinitis); J30.81 (allergic rhinitis due to animal dander)
Level of care requested: OUTPATIENT. Place of service: Physician office.

Submission Contact

Submitted through the provider portal by Mia Sorensen, Authorization Coordinator.
Supporting clinical documentation attached (4 pages including this request).

Allergy and Immunology Consultation

Patient: Dana Okoye, 34-year-old, seen in clinic on 2026-09-15.

History

Nasal congestion, sneezing, itchy watery eyes and postnasal drip every spring and fall, and a milder pattern all year. Symptoms are worst in the weeks of tree pollen and ragweed season and when cleaning the house or being around cats. Allergic conjunctivitis accompanies the rhinitis. Mild asthma is well controlled.

Treatment so far

Environmental control measures are in place: mattress and pillow covers, a HEPA filter in the bedroom, windows closed in pollen season. She has used intranasal fluticasone daily and cetirizine daily for 10 weeks, which is more than 28 consecutive days, with only partial relief. Symptoms still interfere with sleep and work.

Assessment

Allergic rhinitis with conjunctivitis, poorly controlled despite allergen avoidance and medicines. She is currently 14 weeks pregnant.

No beta blocker use. No history of anaphylaxis to immunotherapy. A shared decision making discussion about immunotherapy, including risks and the 3 to 5 year course, took place today and the patient wishes to proceed.

Allergy Skin Testing Report

Patient: Dana Okoye Date of test: 2026-09-22

Method

Percutaneous skin prick testing with a standard aeroallergen panel. Positive control (histamine) wheal 6 mm. Negative control 0 mm.

Results (wheal diameter)

Dust mite, *Dermatophagoides pteronyssinus*: 9 mm (positive).

Dust mite, *Dermatophagoides farinae*: 8 mm (positive).

Oak pollen: 7 mm (positive). Ragweed pollen: 6 mm (positive). Cat dander: 5 mm (positive).

Interpretation

Clinically relevant specific IgE to dust mite, tree pollen, ragweed and cat dander, which matches the history. Serum specific IgE to *Dermatophagoides pteronyssinus* was 12.4 kU/L (class 4).

Immunotherapy Treatment Plan

Patient: Dana Okoye Plan date: 2026-09-29

The antigen extracts will be prepared by Dr. Linda Cho, a physician (MD) who has examined the patient and set the plan of treatment and dosage regimen.

Pregnancy status: the patient is 14 weeks pregnant. Immunotherapy would start during this pregnancy.

Schedule

Build-up: one injection a week for about 6 months, then a maintenance dose once a month. An initial course of 3 to 5 years is planned, with a review every 6 to 12 months.

Safety

Injections are given only in the physician's office, which is equipped to treat anaphylaxis. The patient waits 30 minutes after each injection. Epinephrine is on site and staff are trained in emergency treatment.